

INTERNATIONAL news

US plans \$5 billion critical minerals fund to bolster supply security

The US is negotiating a \$5 billion fund with Orion Resource Partners to secure critical minerals like copper, cobalt, and rare earths. This joint venture with the US International Development Finance Corporation aims to reduce dependence on foreign processing, particularly from China, and strengthen supply chains for clean energy and defence sectors.

Netherlands blocks Chinese control of Nexperia operations

The Dutch government has intervened in Chinese-owned chipmaker Nexperia to prevent sensitive technology transfer to parent Wingtech, invoking the unused 'Availability of Goods Act.' Production continues, but Wingtech's control is temporarily restricted. The move, amid prior US sanctions, aims to protect Dutch and European semiconductor technology, highlighting growing Western scrutiny of Chinese tech firms.

Qualcomm is set to acquire Arduino

Qualcomm Technologies announces its acquisition of Arduino, expanding its reach into the global developer community built around open source hardware. The first outcome of the partnership is the Arduino Uno Q board. It runs on Qualcomm's Dragonwing QRB2210 processor and uses a dual-core setup combining Linux-based computing with real-time microcontroller control.

STMicroelectronics invests \$60 million in French facility

STMicroelectronics will invest \$60 million in its Tours facility in France to establish a pilot production line for advanced semiconductor technologies. The project will further focus on building new infrastructure and reshaping the functions of the company's French and Italian sites to align with long-term growth strategies.



Amkor invests \$7 billion in new Arizona campus

Amkor Technology has begun construction of a semiconductor packaging and testing campus in Peoria, Arizona, US. The \$7 billion project will be completed in two phases, with construction scheduled to finish by mid-2027 and production to begin in early 2028. The Arizona campus will feature 750,000 square feet (69,677 square metres) of cleanroom space and advanced facilities for high-volume chip packaging and testing.

AMD strikes multi-year chip deal with OpenAI

AMD has signed a multi-year deal with OpenAI to supply 6 gigawatts of compute capacity across multiple GPU generations, starting with the MI450. OpenAI can acquire up to a 10% AMD stake tied to stock milestones. The agreement supports OpenAI's AI

infrastructure expansion and positions AMD to compete with Nvidia in large-scale AI workloads.

Global chipmakers' market value soars US\$200 billion amid AI frenzy

Global chipmakers have surged over \$200 billion in market value amid an AI investment boom, driven by OpenAI's \$500 billion valuation and partnerships with Samsung and SK Hynix. Intel's talks with AMD further boosted confidence. Korean chip stocks led gains, with SK Hynix up 10% and Samsung 3.5%, pushing the Kospi Index to record highs, though analysts urge caution.

US startup NanoQT raises \$14 million for quantum interconnect technology

US-based Nanofiber Quantum Technologies has closed the first tranche of a \$14 million Series A financing. The funding follows over \$20 million in government R&D grants in Japan and the United States supporting NanoQT's technology development. The interconnect converts qubit signals into photonic signals with minimal loss, supporting modular quantum processors and potential networked systems.

Australia's Morse Micro secures fund to scale IoT 2.0

Morse Micro has secured AU\$88 million in Series C funding, strengthening its position as a leader in Wi-Fi HaLow technology. This brings the firm's total funding to more than AU\$290 million. The capital will be used to scale production of Morse Micro's Wi-Fi HaLow chips, expand its global footprint, and push forward the industry shift to 'IoT 2.0'.

OpenAI and Nvidia set to finalise 10GW AI infra

OpenAI and Nvidia plan to deploy at least 10 GW of Nvidia GPUs to power OpenAI's AI infrastructure for next-generation models and future superintelligence. The first 1GW will arrive in late 2026 using Nvidia's Vera Rubin GPUs. Nvidia will invest up to \$100 billion, involving millions of GPUs to support this massive deployment.

iDEAL launches SuperQ power devices at Polar's foundry

iDEAL Semiconductor launched its SuperQ power devices at Polar Semiconductor's Minnesota facility, featuring a patented asymmetrical RESURF structure. These MOSFETs deliver up to 2.7x lower resistance and 2.1x reduced switching losses, supporting high-performance applications like automotive, AI data centres, and renewable energy. Production began with 150V and 200V devices, expanding to 300V and 400V variants.

Blackstone in talks to acquire Zelestra's India business in \$421 million deal

Blackstone is in talks to acquire Zelestra's India business for around \$421 million, including \$184 million in equity. The portfolio includes 600MW operational, 2GW contracted, and 1.5GW under construction, targeting 8.6GW by 2031. Managed by JP Morgan under 'Project Orange,' the deal will help Blackstone establish a new renewable energy platform in India.

Samsung's Harman completes \$350 million Sound United acquisition

Samsung subsidiary Harman has completed its \$350 million acquisition of Sound United, incorporating premium audio brands like Bowers & Wilkins, Denon, Marantz, and Polk Audio. Operating as a standalone unit within Harman's lifestyle division, the deal expands Harman's high-end audio portfolio alongside JBL and Harman Kardon, boosting scale, product diversity, and growth opportunities in the consumer audio market.